

Last time we introduced the question of what we should believe. We began by considering this rule of belief:

No Proof $\rightarrow$ No Belief

If you can't give a good
argument for P, don't
believe P.

But we saw that this led to the result that you should not believe anything at all, which seems very implausible.

At the very least, it seems, we should believe things that we can be certain of:

This is a version of a view known as foundationalism.

It can be summed up with the following negative rule of belief:

Certainty $\rightarrow$ Belief

If you can rule out any situation which would make P false, you should believe P.

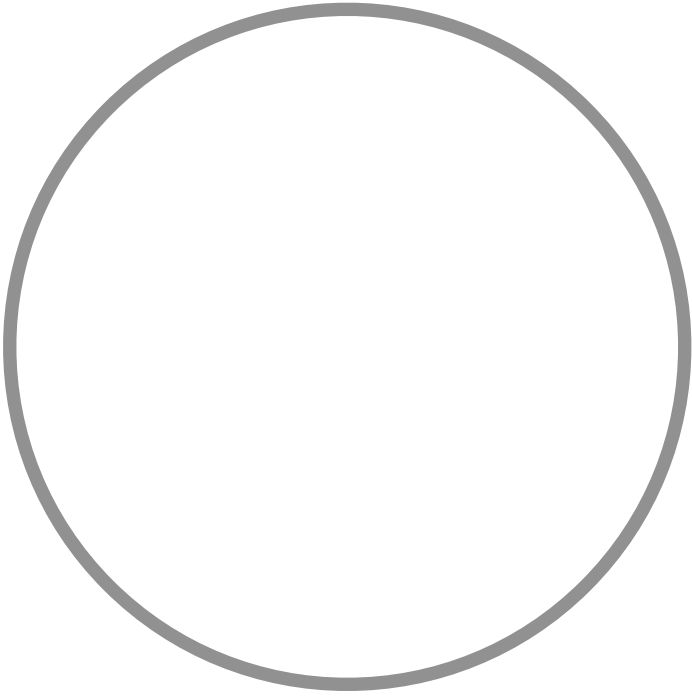
Experience → Belief

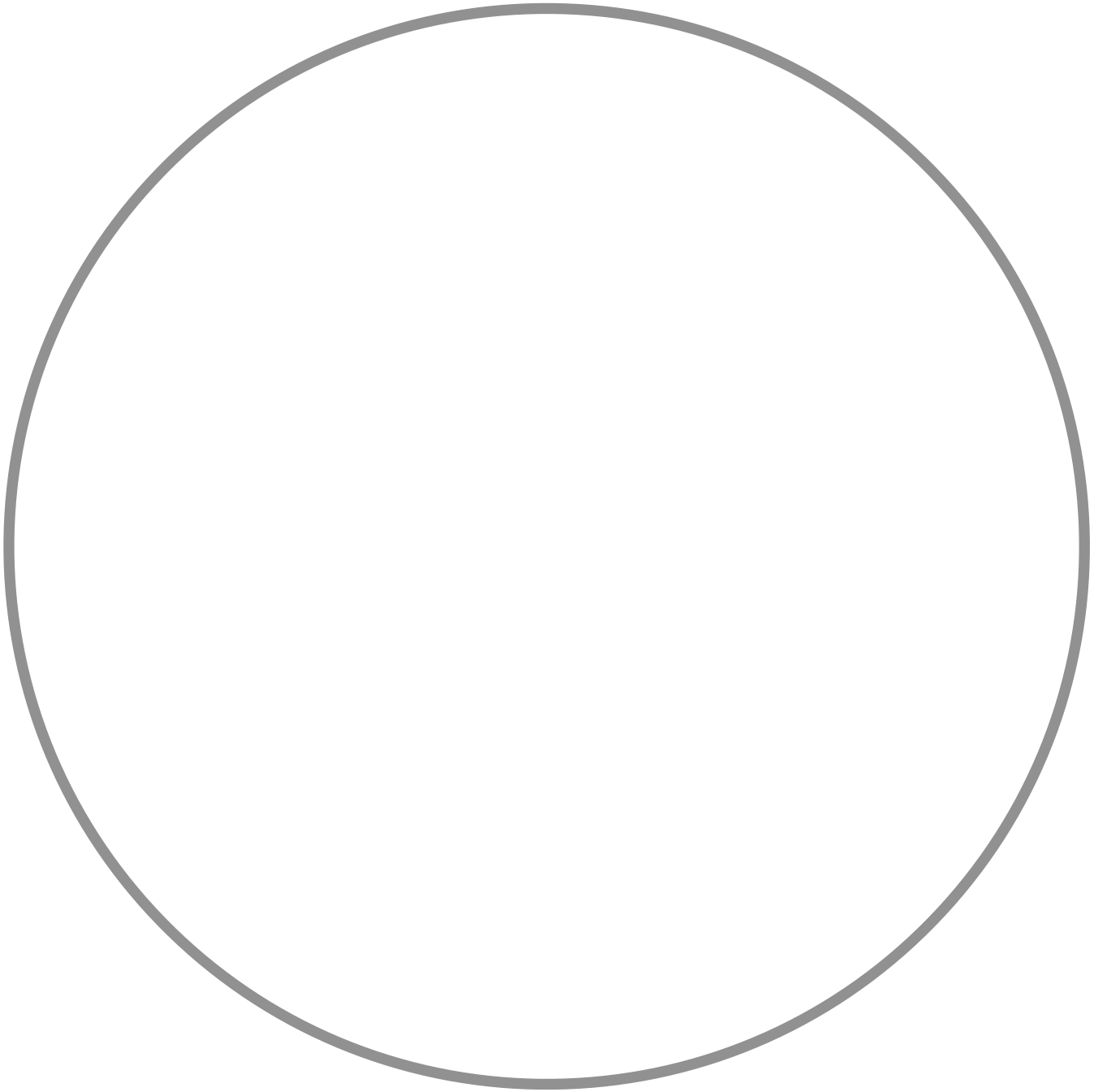
If your sense experience tells you that P, and you have no reason to think that your sense experience is misleading, you should believe P.

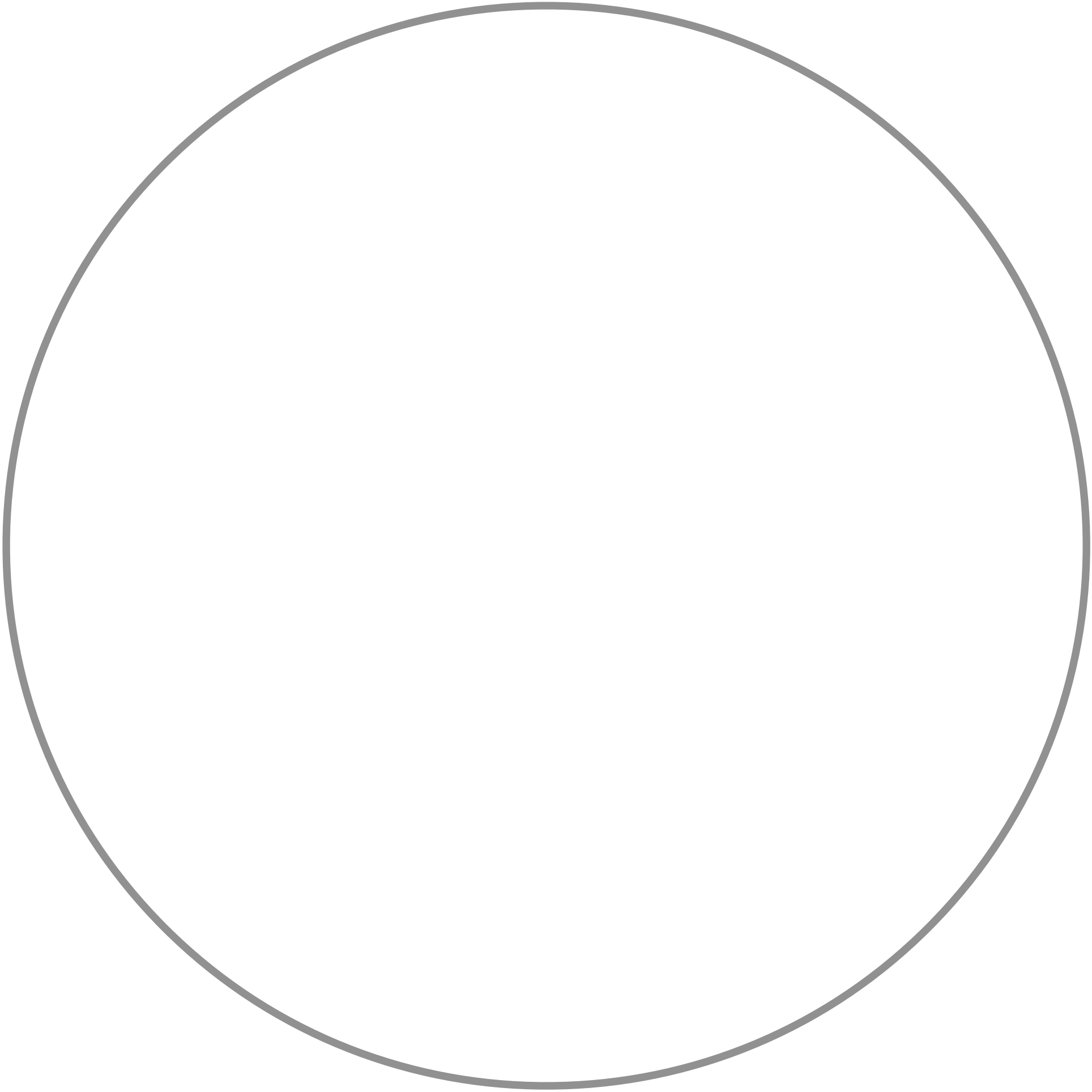
Good Argument $\rightarrow$ Belief

If there is a valid argument for P and you should believe each of that argument's premises, you should believe P.

We can compare
this to some of the
other negative rules
of belief we have
considered.







No
Foundations
→ No Belief

Doubt →
No Belief

No Good
Argument
→ No Belief



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yesterday.

Next class, we'll ask
whether No
Foundations $\rightarrow$ No
Belief is true.

considering this rule of belief:

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certainty $\rightarrow$ Belief

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If you can't find it

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Experience → Belief

If your sense experience

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We can compare

other negative rules



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Forwards



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Argument



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Foundations → No

Next class, we'll ask